

A TRUE HORROR STORY

ANABELLA

SHE WAS NEVER JUST A DOLL

Based on the documented case files of paranormal investigators Ed and Lorraine Warren. The events described herein are real.

THE GIFT

In 1970, a mother purchased an antique Raggedy Ann doll from a hobby store as a gift for her daughter Donna, a nursing student living with her roommate Angie in a small Hartford apartment.

The doll was old. Worn. Its button eyes seemed to follow whoever entered the room. Donna placed it on her bed and thought nothing more of it — at first.

HARTFORD, CONNECTICUT

Autumn, 1970

THE RESIDENTS

Donna. Angie. And soon — something else.

SOMETHING STIRS

01 THE DOLL MOVES

Donna and Angie returned home each day to find the doll in a different position — legs crossed, arms raised, seated in a chair across the room.

02 ROOM TO ROOM

They began marking the doll's position before leaving. Upon returning, it had moved. Not slightly — completely across the apartment.

03 PARCHMENT NOTES

Scraps of parchment paper — none belonging to either girl — began appearing with a childlike scrawl: "Help Us."

CHAPTER THREE

"HELP US"

The notes were written on parchment paper the girls had never purchased. No pen was found. No explanation for how the handwriting appeared. The same two words, over and over, in the same childlike script.

A medium was consulted. She claimed to channel the spirit of a girl named Annabelle Higgins — a seven-year-old who had died on the property decades before. She only wanted to be loved, the medium said.

THE ATTACK

Lou — a friend who had always distrusted the doll — woke one night unable to move, paralyzed in his bed. He felt a presence choking the air from the room.

Then he looked down and saw it — Anabella had crawled up onto his chest. Its button eyes stared directly into his. He blacked out.

THE NEXT MORNING, DEEP CLAW MARKS — SEVEN PARALLEL SCRATCHES — WERE FOUND ACROSS LOU'S CHEST. THEY BURNED LIKE FIRE. THEY HEALED WITHIN HOURS.

THE WARRENS ARRIVE

Desperate, Donna and Angie contacted a priest, who in turn reached out to renowned paranormal investigators Ed and Lorraine Warren. The couple had investigated hundreds of hauntings across the country.

Lorraine Warren, a clairvoyant, walked into the apartment and immediately felt a powerful malevolent energy. She did not approach the doll. She stood in the doorway and studied it from a distance.

ED WARREN

Demonologist. U.S. Navy veteran. Founder of the New England Society for Psychic Research.

LORRAINE WARREN

Clairvoyant and light trance medium. She refused to touch the doll directly.

NOT A GHOST

Ed Warren's conclusion was unequivocal: there was no child named Annabelle Higgins. There was no human spirit. What had attached itself to the doll was something far older and far more dangerous.

The entity had manufactured the story of the dead child to earn the girls' sympathy — to be invited closer, given permission to stay. This is how a demon gains a foothold.

WARREN'S ASSESSMENT

"THIS IS NOT A HAUNTED OBJECT.
THIS IS AN INHUMAN SPIRIT. A
DEMONIC ENTITY OF
SIGNIFICANT POWER."

— Ed Warren, 1970

THE EXORCISM

Father Cook of the Episcopal Church was brought in to perform a blessing of the apartment and the doll. During the ritual, items flew from shelves. The temperature in the room plunged to freezing.

The doll did not burn. It did not tear. It sat precisely where it had been placed, button eyes unchanged, as if it was merely waiting for the disruption to end.

ROOM TEMPERATURE

Dropped to below freezing mid-ritual despite the heating running at full power.

OBJECTS DISPLACED

Books, crucifixes, and picture frames were hurled across the room by an unseen force.

THE DOLL

Completely still throughout. Untouched by the chaos around it.

CHAPTER EIGHT

THE TRANSFER

Ed Warren carried the doll out of the apartment himself, wrapped in a white sheet blessed by the Church. He placed it in the back seat of his car. It did not stay there.

Three times during the drive, the doll appeared in the front seat. The steering wheel jerked violently. The car nearly left the road at speed on multiple occasions. Ed prayed aloud the entire journey.

LOCKED AWAY FOREVER

The doll was placed inside a specially constructed glass case in the Warrens' Occult Museum in Monroe, Connecticut. The case is blessed by a Catholic priest every month without exception.

A sign on the case reads: "Warning. Positively do not open." Visitors who mocked the doll have reported accidents on the road home. One died.

"THE DOLL IS NOT POSSESSED. THE DOLL IS A CONDUIT — AN ANCHOR FOR SOMETHING THAT HAS NO FORM OF ITS OWN."

— Lorraine Warren